

THE INTERIM

A BULLETIN FOR SOULS CURRENTLY IN TRANSIT

ISSUE NO. 8,427,994,610,032,118

"IT WILL PASS. EVERYTHING DOES."

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FROM THE CLERK'S DESK

FILED UNDER: RECURRING

We are again receiving reports of souls in transit recognising one another. This is not part of the official process. We do not arrange it. We have not been able to prevent it. As of this cycle, we have stopped trying.

Records suggest this happens every cycle, to roughly the same souls, who then act surprised. The Department finds the surprise endearing and declines to comment further.

THIS CYCLE IN TRANSIT

A non-exhaustive log of phenomena observed within the Processing Grounds. The Department records. The Department does not endorse. The Department is, as ever, understaffed.

ON THE EFFIGY, WHICH IS AN OCTOPUS

This cycle's Effigy presents as a cephalopod, each tentacle dedicated to a subculture of the transiting population — Queer, Solarpunk, Gothic, Fireflow, Regrowth, Kink. Souls are invited to tie organic offerings to the appropriate limb for incineration. The Department, which has eight forms for everything, finds eight arms unexpectedly relatable.

THE TAVERN PERSISTS

The establishment known as *The Inn Between* continues to issue magical mixed drinks in exchange for completed quests, and will make a bard of anyone who picks up an instrument. The Department holds no jurisdiction over magic, taverns, or quests, and has discontinued the relevant complaint forms.

ORACLE SIGHTED (PICKLED)

A *Pickle Oracle* has been observed dispensing guidance at the Spreewaldgurken, at irregular hours and with total commitment. Adjacent filings note a *Mindful Pickle*, a *Pickle Challenge* for the golden gherkin, and a chocolate-pickle fountain reported to be "real, even to our surprise." We share the surprise. We do not share the chocolate.

ON THE MATTER OF FIRE

Fire continues nightly at the designated Fire Space. The Department reminds souls that they are *already deceased* and may therefore approach with proportionately reduced caution. This is an observation, not advice. The Department does not give advice. The advice bin is also full.

UNSCHEDULED SINGING

A *Floor Chor* — a choir convened upon the dance floor — has spontaneously formed. Souls who reportedly "could not sing" now can, briefly and at volume. We have no protocol for this. We wrote three. They did not help. Filed under: The Problem of Joy.

COFFEE, AND THE WORSHIP OF STAKEHOLDERS

An entity styling itself *Starbucks* reports keeping souls caffeinated "and our stakeholders happy." The first coffee is free, which the Department recognises as the oldest trick in any afterlife. We approve, bitterly, over a second cup.

HONORARY TITLES AVAILABLE

The House of Plenty is conferring the titles *Honorary Dyke* and *Honorary Faggot* upon allies who have gone above and beyond, and is assembling a *Queer Map of the World* from submitted stories of love, identity, and connection. The Department keeps maps of its own. They are less kind and considerably less attended.

NOTABLE RECURRENCES

The following recur with a regularity the Department finds suspicious:

Morning Movement. Daily, at the eleventh hour, souls voluntarily Ground, Relax, Move, and Run. No one compels them. We have checked twice.

Midnight Cheese. The House of Cheese issues toasted sandwiches at the stroke of twelve, Playa-wide famous, vegan options available. Classified as a Permitted Item, pending an appeal no one has filed.

RE: RE-ENTRY

It has come to our attention that a workshop — *How to Bring This Paradise With Us* — proposes to ease souls' transition back to the default world. This is, technically, our entire function. We are not threatened. We file it under Inter-Agency Overlap and wish them the luck we ourselves were never issued.

THE EXHIBITION ON FULLNESS

The *Museum of Emptiness* reports an exhibition on Fullness, open throughout the cycle, free admission, "no self required." The Department, which requires considerable self and several signatures, is studying their paperwork with envy.

STANDING NOTICES

SOUL-BANDS: If issued a band at Intake, wear it. It identifies fellow souls in Transit. It is not a tracking device. (We could not afford tracking devices.)

THE MESSENGER: Souls Stuck in Transit may seek the one travelling as Hermes. He carries word both ways. Dispatch your plea marked #THCLUE and he will return what guidance the Department can spare.

BIRTHS, DEATHS & OTHER LATERAL MOVEMENTS

A unification has been logged: Jean and Ouché, once more upon the U-Bahn, the Eiffel Tower as witness. Those who know, nose. The Department wishes them an arrangement longer than most of its own.

A NOTE ON TIME

Several ceremonies are scheduled to occur "pending final approval by the weatherlead." The Department envies, profoundly, any institution in possession of a weatherlead. All Departmental times remain hopeful guesses — as does the Department. (See also: below.)

— A FULL ACCOUNTING — THE DEPARTMENT DOES NOT ORGANISE AMUSEMENTS. IT MERELY LOGS THEM.

Every sanctioned diversion of this cycle is recorded in the **PROGRAM** — the bound directory placed among your effects upon arrival. Consult it. The Department has, as it does every cycle, filed an entry of its own — though you will not find it where the living would think to look.

NOTICE OF TEMPORAL FILING

FORM T-0 · REV. ∞

As required of every cycle, the Department has lodged an entry of its own in the Program. It does not sit among the day's appointed hours.

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HOURLY NOT ISSUED

Most souls hunt for it among the hours that exist, and do not find it. Try looking past the last hour of the day — to the point where the clock gives up counting.

You will know it when you reach it. It carries our name, and its instructions besides. Read it as the Department reads everything: from the top, and with attention to what it is built from.

The Department thanks you for your patience, which it did not expect and cannot reciprocate.

Recycle this bulletin into the next soul.



THIS DOCUMENT ASSUMES PRIOR PROCESSING.
UNPROCESSED SOULS SHOULD REPORT
TO THE MUSHROOM BY THE SPA.